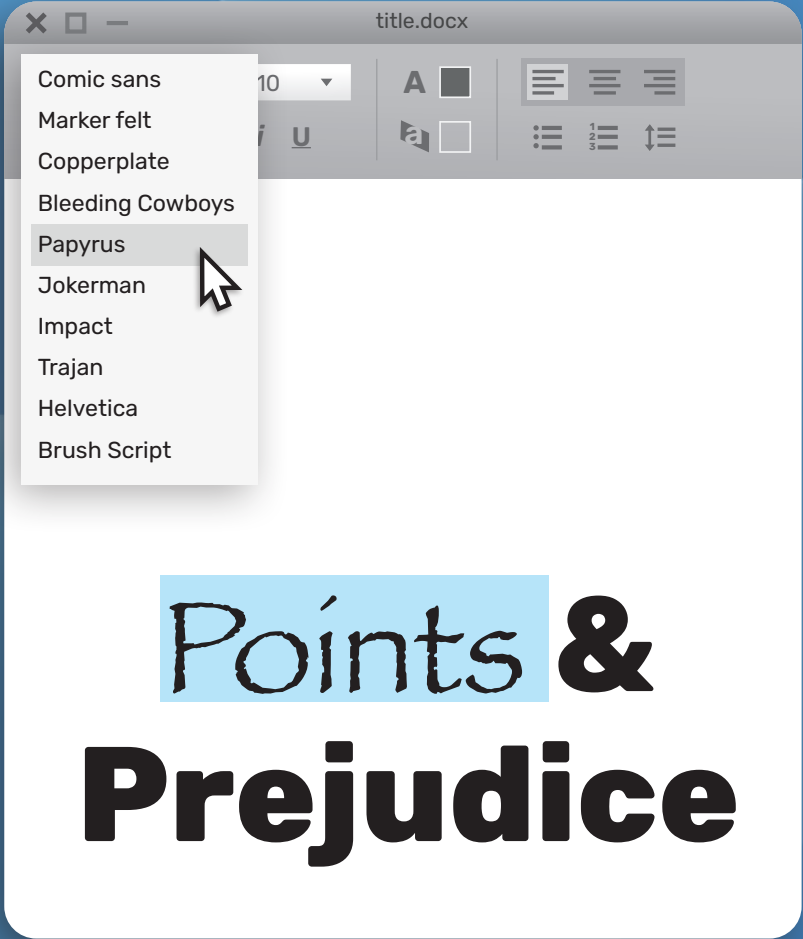


Benjamin Kimberley

Is a peculiar specimen of humanity who partakes in a wide variety of activities such as typesetting, type reading, music making, game coding, picture drawing, and rolling down large grassy hills. He subsists on a diet of apples, cucumbers, and scotch mints. Currently he resides somewhere in the mountains with a small beetle.



Within these pages...

You will find a great array of words. These words are made up of letters. These letters come in a staggering variety of shapes and sizes, enough to suit any manner of mood or circumstance. What fun!

Although perhaps there are some letters which, upon inspection, you find to be significantly less pleasing to the eye. One might say they rub you the wrong way; they ruffle your feathers; they court your ill favor. You may peer upon them with your brow furrowed in burgeoning disgust. Who would select such a set of letters to make up the words in their book? Worse still, what misguided soul would construct these letters thus, that I should look upon them and find within me a penchant for typographic hatred heretofore unseen? Who dares provoke my sensibilities? Where do they get on?

When you have finished this book, you will have the answers you seek.



The Fonts We Despise,
and the Folks Who Made Them

Benjamin Kimberley



title again.rtf

Points & Prejudice

The Fonts We Despise,
and the Folks Who Made Them

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4 Comic Sans.ttf



6 Copperplate.ttf



8 Bleeding
Cowboys.ttf



10 Brush Script.ttf



12 Trajan.ttf



14 Marker Felt.ttf



16 Helvetica.ttf



18 Jokerman.ttf



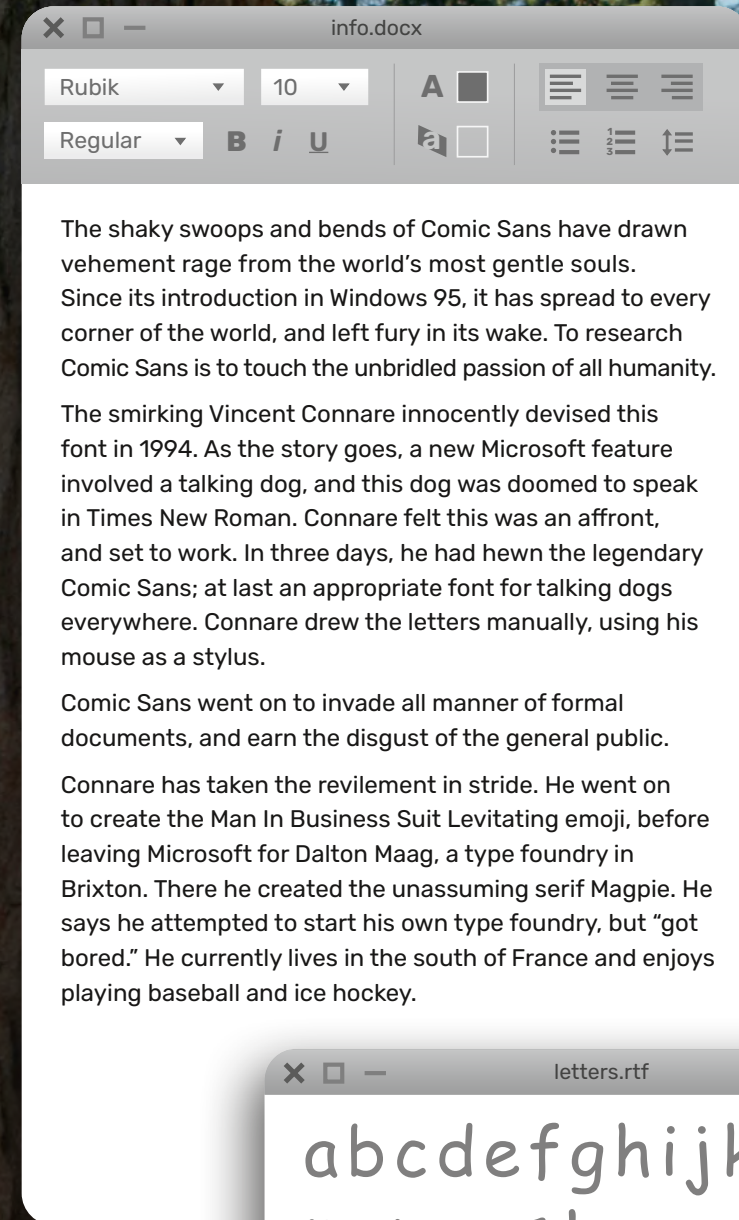
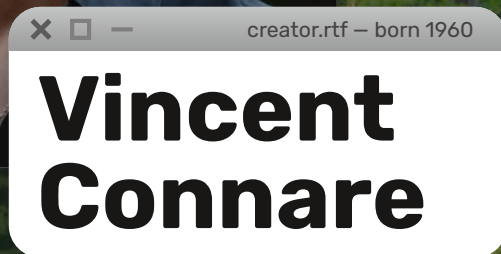
20 Impact.ttf



22 Papyrus.ttf

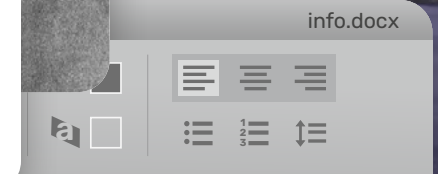
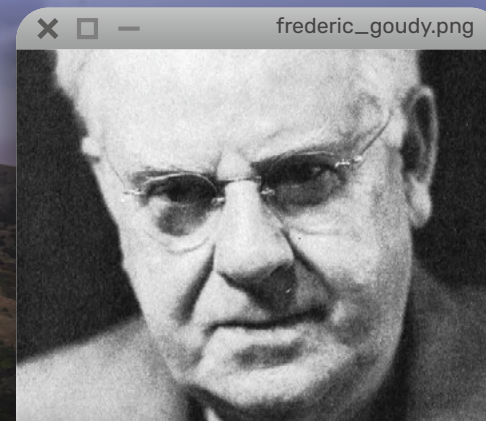


"You can have the haters out there, it's fine. Not everybody loves Justin Bieber."





"Copperplate is a blight that should be eradicated from public life"
—I Hate Copperplate on Flickr



Copperplate is a mainstay in the hallowed halls of typefaces commonly reviled by the general public. Its extended, globular curves and pitiful serifs have caused it to draw the ire of countless fine fellows. Usually it can be found adorning the glass of a lawyers office, set in a regal arc.

Frederic Goudy is a much-loved type designer whose career began when he idly sketched an alphabet and mailed it to the Dickenson Type Foundry. He asked for five dollars and earned ten. This was in the age when type was carved by hand, and fine motor skills were paramount. Goudy fiddled not with the unruly vector and payed no heed to obtuse programs and their hidden state. The one-hundredth typeface that he produced he dedicated to his wife, expressing his gratitude for her endless support. I hope she recieved some sort of baked good or fancy dinner as well. His other creations include Goudy Old Style, which is a lovely serif. I dare say that I could read a whole book in that serif and I would never think to declare, "My word! What tumultuous type! This must be that Copperplate fellow!"

Bleeding Cowboys

info.docx

Rubik 10

Regular **B** *i* U

Avert your gaze from the swirling, oozing monstrosity which invades the page beside this text! The longer one stares at such a specimen of abhorrence, the further defiled their mind shall become!

This violation graced the album covers of country metal artists for years, staking ground betwixt the shoulder-slung guitars and studded denim jackets. It was created by Guillaume Séguin, also known as Segments Design, also known as Thunder Toast, who frequented dafont.com in the late 2000s and has since made a new life as a freelance photographer. Séguin is from Quebec. He thinks "Bleeding Cowboys is to fonts what Nickelback is to rock 'n' roll."

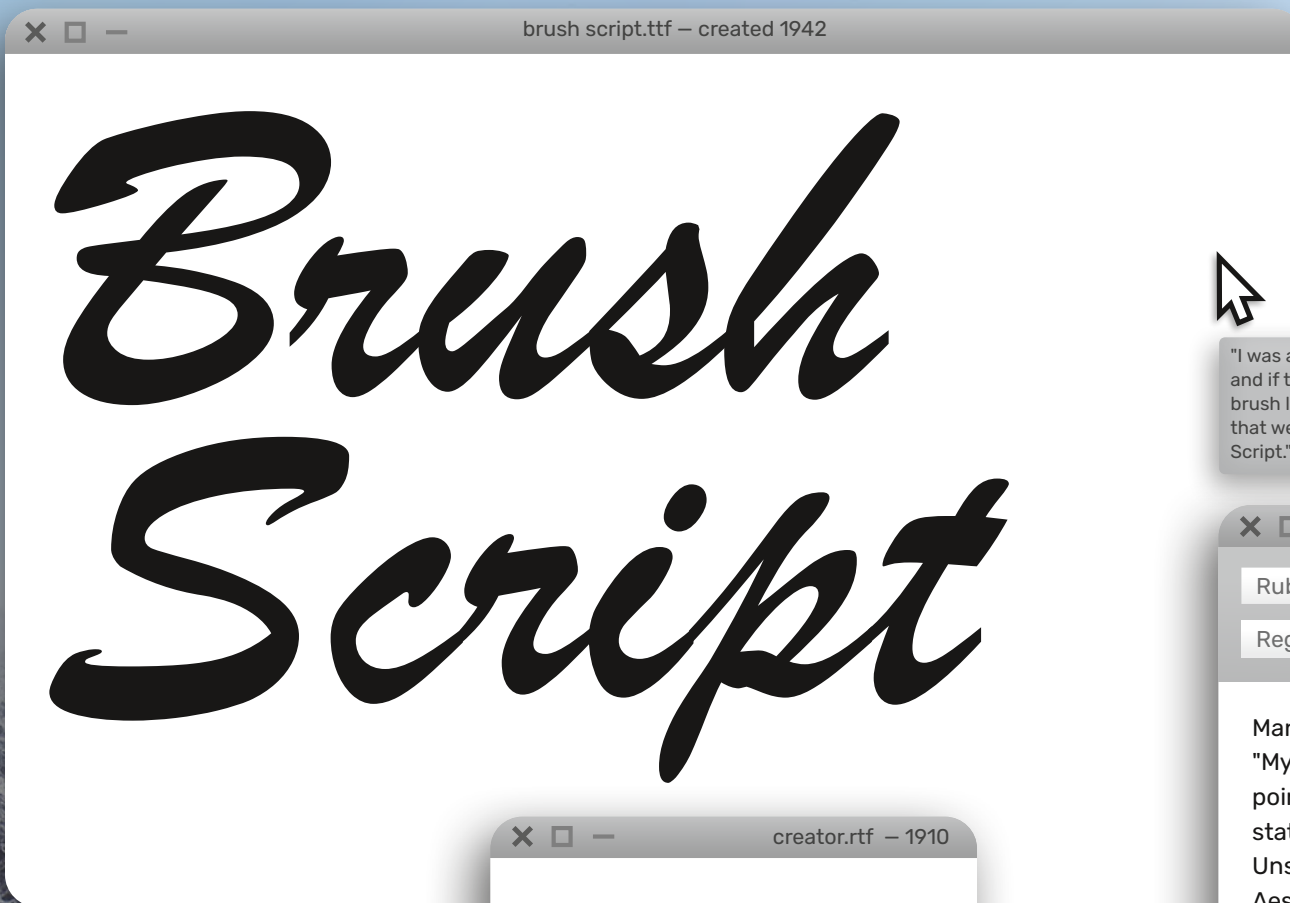
Now please, dear reader, turn the page and gaze no further upon this fecund flamboyance.

letters.rtf

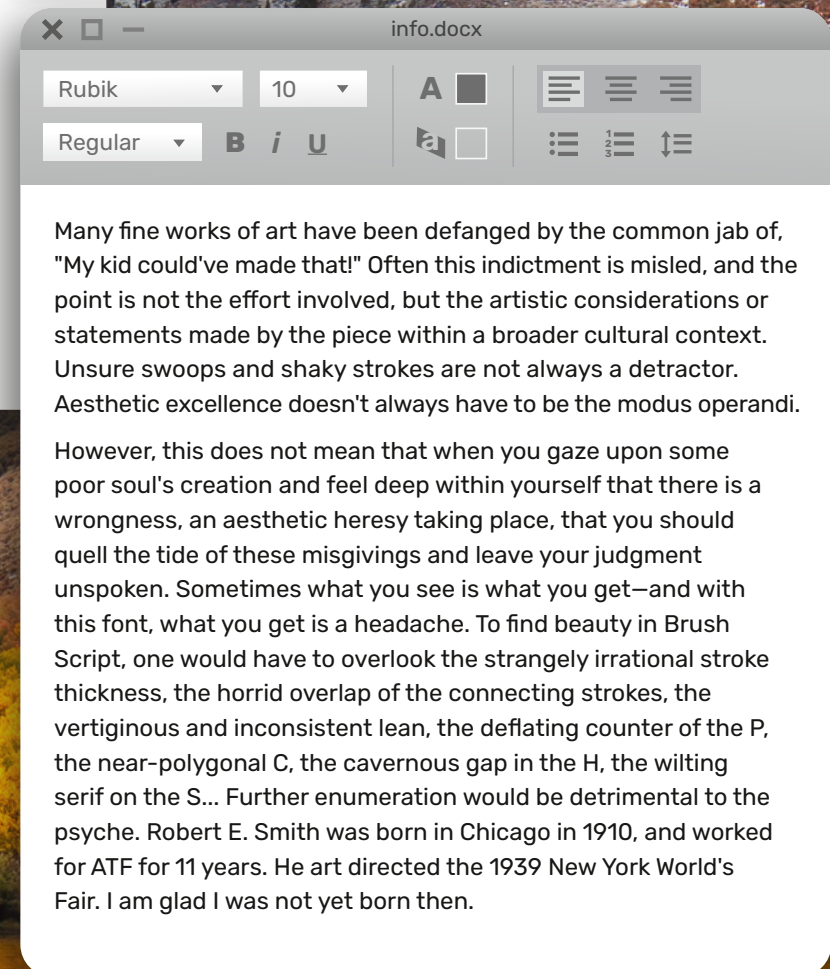
A B C D E
F G H I J K
L M N O P
Q R S T U
V W X Y Z

creator.rtf – born 1983

**Guillaume
Séguin**

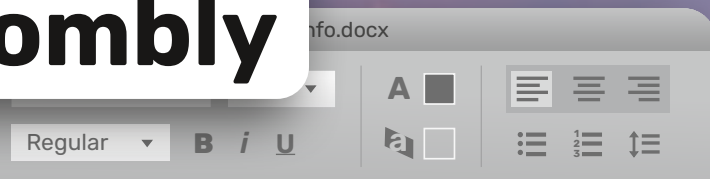


"I was a sign man for thirty years and if there was one thing proper brush letterers agreed on, it was that we all hated and reviled Brush Script." — Kerry Kruger





"a typeface that only a corporate consultant could love" -Trajansucks.com

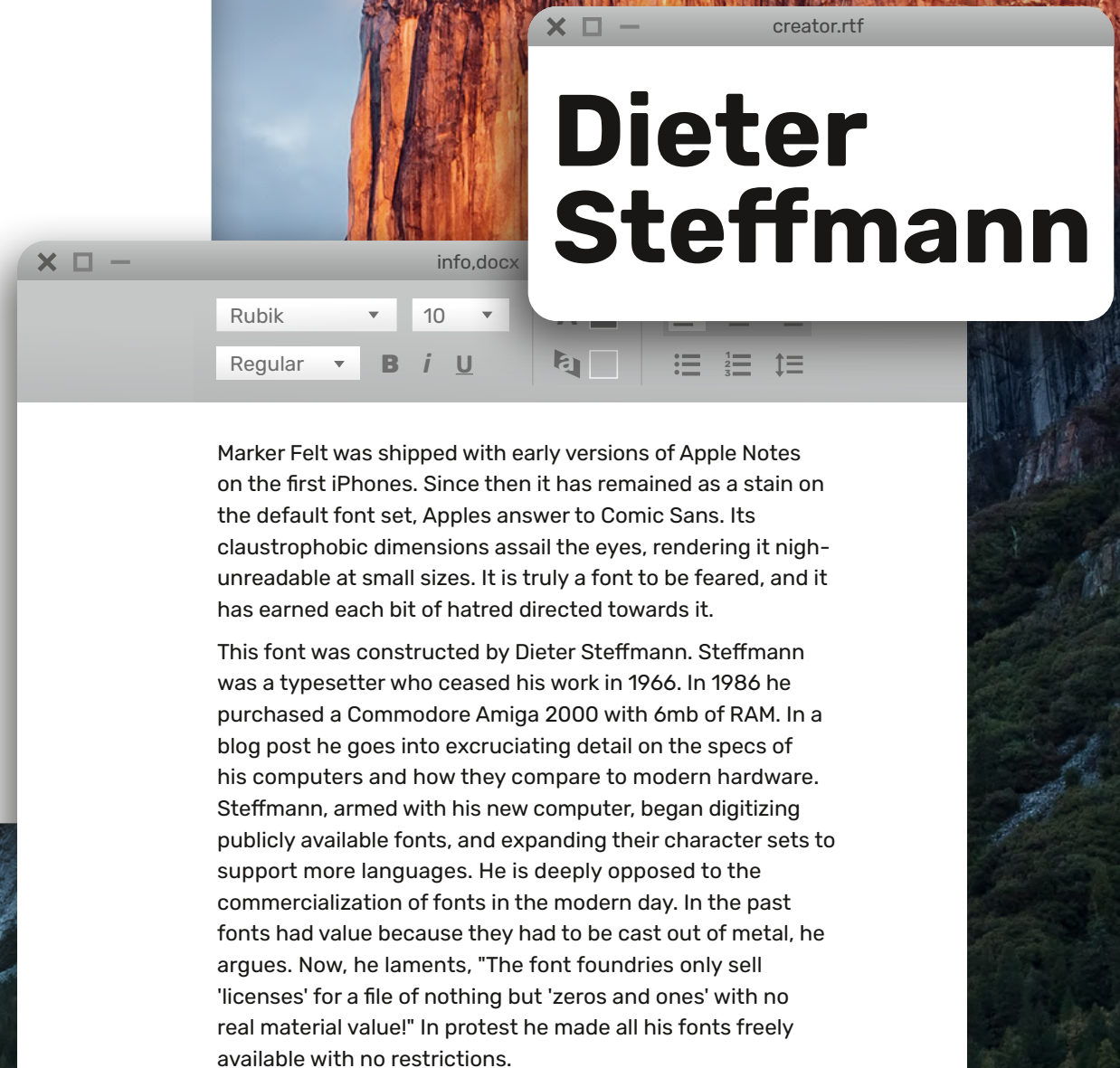


Trajan isn't necessarily odious by nature; it has simply been dragged out unceremoniously to be smeared across dramatic movie posters one too many times, or perhaps several hundred too many times. Its once noble stature is now the face of pastiche, boasting a hollow grandeur best deployed in the realm of satirical invented blockbusters, paired with poorly composited floating visages of celebrity actors. Its widespread cinematic usage is a well-documented phenomenon.

This typeface was fashioned by Carol Twombly, who sought to faithfully recreate the lettering on Roman movie posters. There were no lowercase letters on these columns because Romans yell all the time. Other typographers with less nice hair had tried to copy the regal Roman letterforms before, but Twombly did it best because she was super cool and good at her job. She studied sculpture before changing her major to graphic design, which is the kind of factoid that graphic designers love and amateur sculpturists are sick of hearing. Through her life she designed a myriad of other typefaces. Many of her symbologies were based upon obscure forms of historical writing. In 1999 she left Adobe because it sucks, and is now doing much cooler things like basket weaving and textile painting.

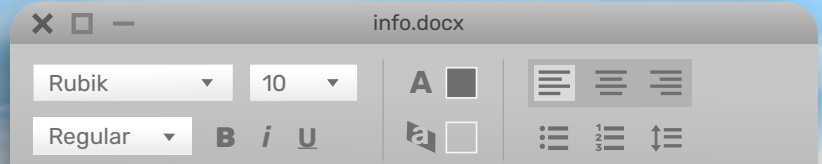


"I'd have to say that Marker felt ranks right up there with comic sans. Sure it looks like a marker, but that doesn't make it cool." —Amanda Kern





Max Miedinger

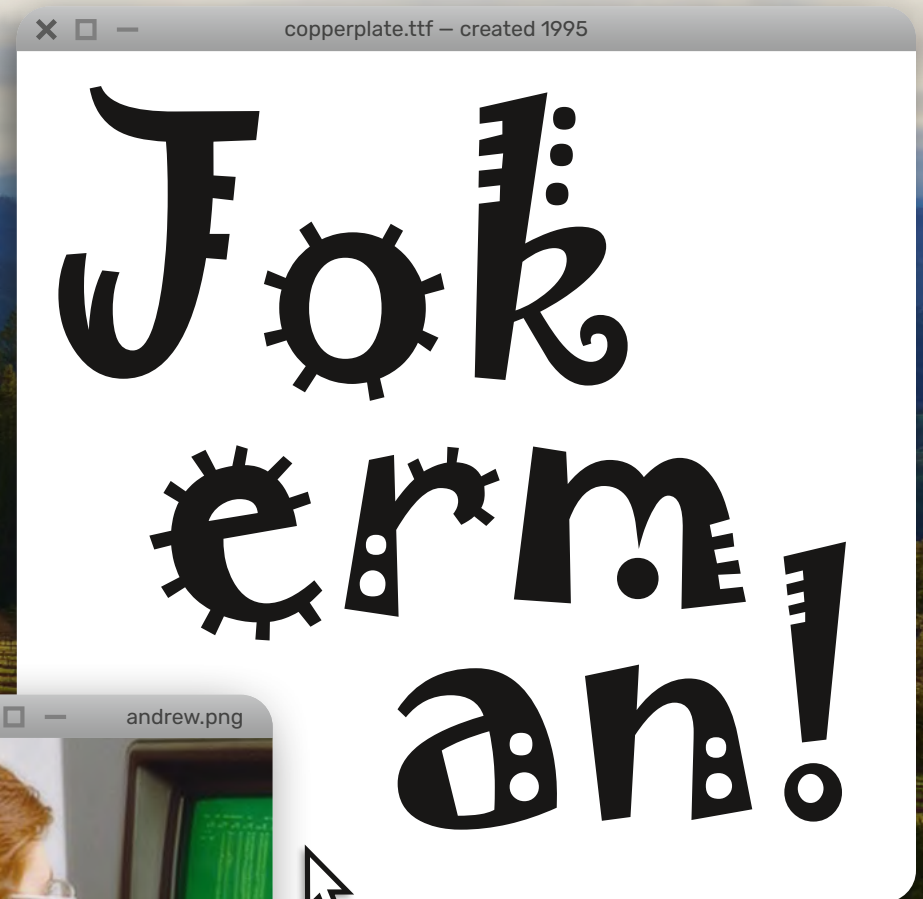
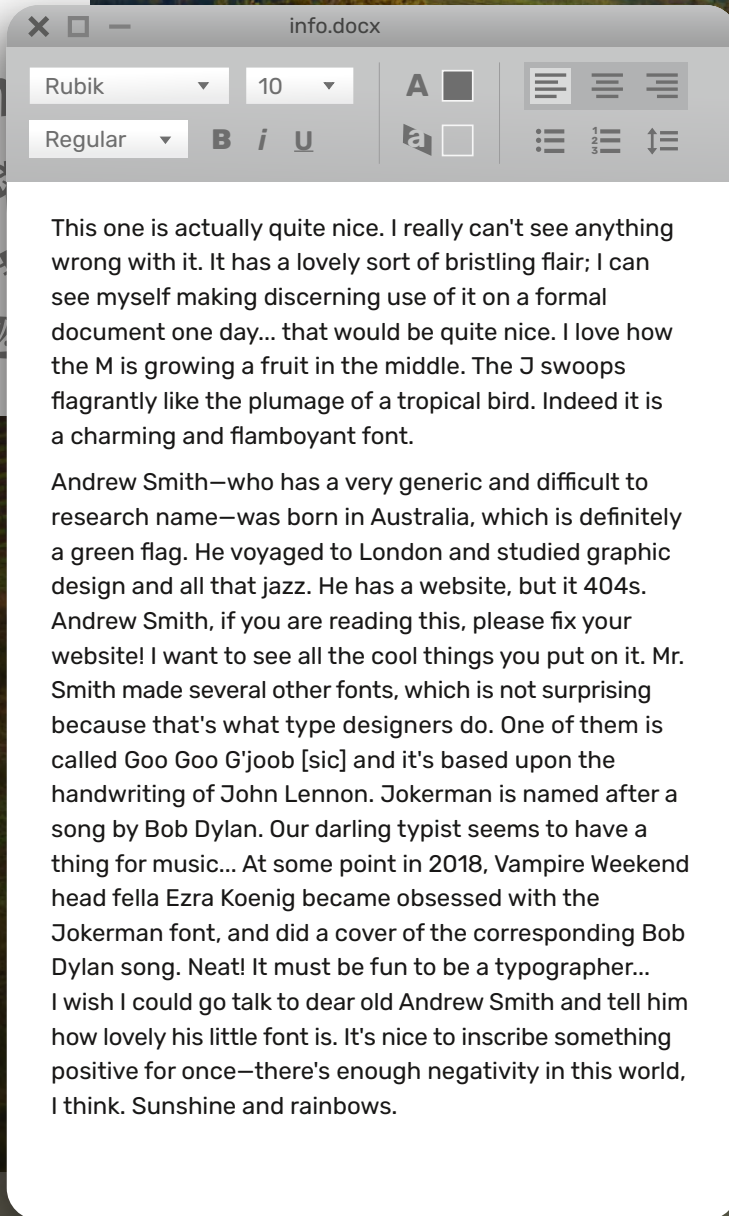


What a perfect font! So inoffensive and bereft of specificity. The very picture of absence, perplexingly evocative in the sense that it evokes nothing much at all. Typography could have ceased its efforts once Helvetica was born; truly it is the paragon of alphabets, the nothingness we have sought for so long. Helvetica is what your mother imagines when you say "font." It is to type what Taylor Swift is to popular music. Perhaps prestigious type practitioners incite such indictment of this font for its surefire suitability which then threatens the indispensable inclusion of their tenuous typographic tact. Who knows?!

Max Miedinger probably thinks of Helvetica in much the same way that Radiohead thinks of Creep, or the Rheostatics of Claire. However Miedinger himself did not quite receive worldwide fame alongside his typeface, so perhaps the resemblance is more akin to a Jonny Greenwood or Martin Tilleli. Miedinger was paid royalties for Helvetica, which is nice. The font was used in Apple products until Apple designed San Francisco, which is another font that looks almost exactly the same. Helvetica has also been used in pretty much everything else in the whole universe. You should really listen to the Rheostatics.

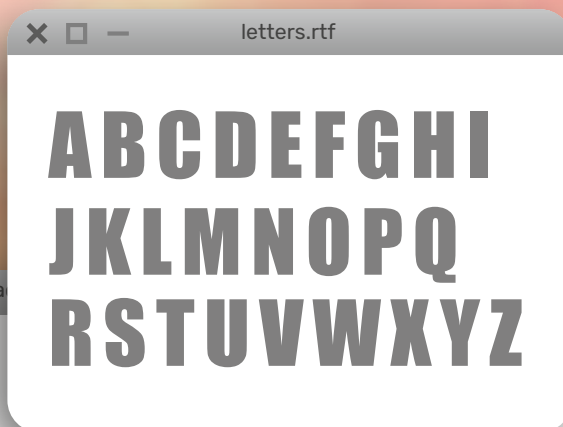


"When people say they prefer Helvetica to Arial because the latter is a bad copy, I ask if there's a difference between a Big Mac and a Whopper, and more to the point, would you honestly feed either to your kids?" -Alastair Johnston

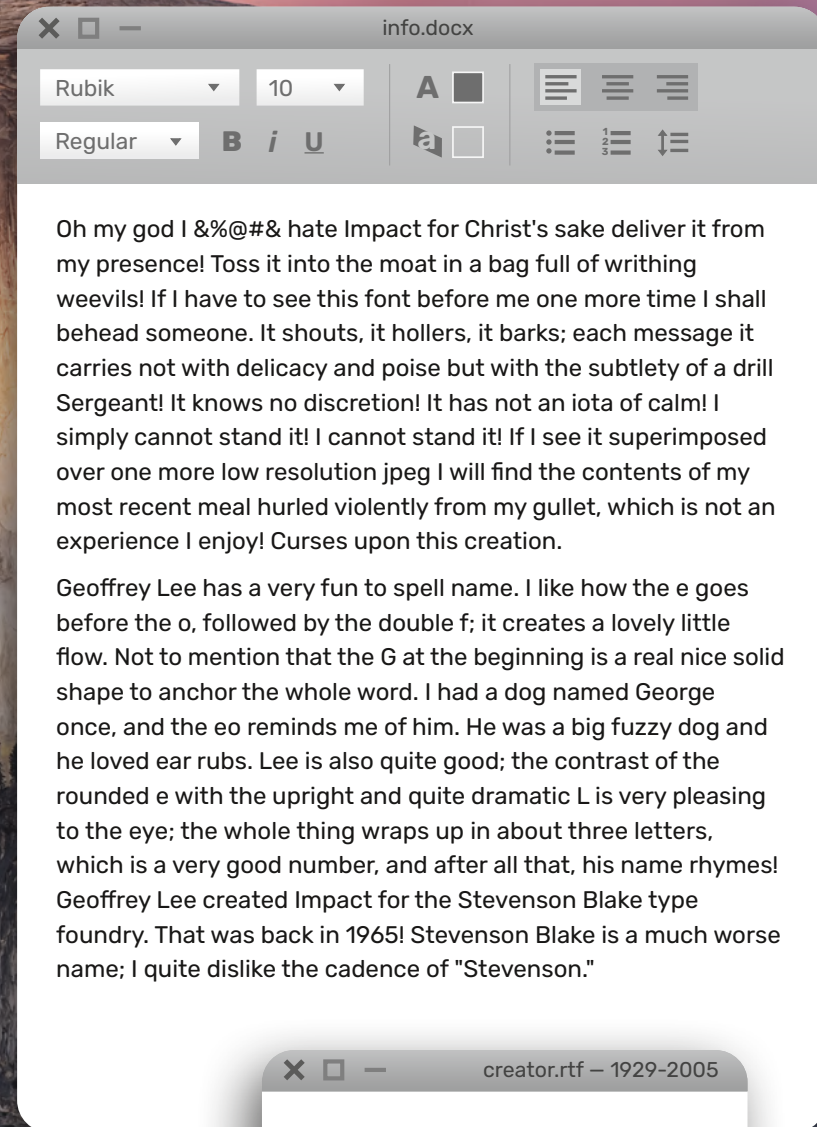


"Whether you're a stand up comic, a children's entertainer or an actual medieval joker, never use Jokerman."
-Mason Kingsbury

A screenshot of a web browser window. The address bar at the top shows the URL 'creator.rtf -born 1967'. The main content area of the browser displays the name 'Andrew Smith' in a large, bold, black, sans-serif font. The browser's interface elements, including the address bar and window controls, are visible at the top.



Impact



Chris Costello

What is there to say? Any rational soul is surely rendered speechless in the face of such a font. The x-height is limbo dancing with the devil. The texture gives it a classic partially-eaten-by-caterpillars charm. The curves lash like a mad serpent to and fro. And yet this font adorns my own mothers business cards. It is acerbic. It is omnipresent. It is fastidious. Who would make such a thing?

Chris Costello, who spends most of his time designing coins. He takes a creative retreat every year. He believes Papyrus is overused, but fundamentally a good font. He drew it while bored at work. He went on to create several other fonts, available on his website, which follow a similar pattern of inane textures and absurd dimensions. Dear reader, I beg you to visit his website; it must be seen to be believed. Here is his description of Papyrus:

"Papyrus is a unique typeface that effectively merges the elegance of traditional Roman letterforms with the hand-crafted feel of calligraphy. Inspired by ancient Mediterranean culture and the Bible, it has a number of distinctive characteristics including high horizontal strokes, rough edges, and sweeping curves. It also includes an additional set of extreme swash initial caps to enhance its unique style."

PA
PY
RUS

abcdef
ghijklm
nopqrs
tuvwxyz

"The road to Hell is paved with good intentions, and the signs along the way are most likely printed in Papyrus"
- Papyrus Everywhere on Flickr

